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17 SUMMARY OF OUTCOMES

17.1 Overview

17.1.1 **Section 2** outlines the details and benefits of the Project together with the consideration of alternatives during the Recommended Outline Development Plan (RODP) stage, which has taken into account public concerns and findings of various engineering and environmental review. The technical assessments in **Sections 3** to **15** have demonstrated that all the statutory requirements in the Study Brief No. ESB-363/2023 under the Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance (EIAO) and the Technical Memorandum on Environmental Impact Assessment Process (EIAO-TM) have been complied with.

17.1.2 This chapter summarises the key environmental outcomes arising from this Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) study, the approaches that have been adopted to either avoid or minimise various environmental impacts throughout the design process, and the associated environmental enhancements and mitigation measures.

17.2 Environmental Benefits of the Project

17.2.1 The Project aspires to capitalise the development potential brought about by the Ngau Tam Mei (NTM) Station of Northern Link (hereinafter referred to as "NOL Main Line") by replanning the brownfields and adjoining area for supporting the future development of Hong Kong. Meanwhile, the proposed UniTown will offer space for activities relating to research and development and groom high-calibre talents to support the innovation and technology development in San Tin Technopole (STT), promoting "research, academic and industry" collaboration, as well as training more doctors to dovetail with Hong Kong's development as an international health and medical innovation hub. Apart from providing comprehensive healthcare services for the existing and new population in the NM, the Integrated Hospital will be developed into a three-in-one teaching, training and research facility, providing training for medical and healthcare professionals, and conducting clinical trials and scientific research to facilitate the advancement of patient care. Through the Project, government, institution and community (GIC) facilities will be provided to support the existing and future residential population in the Northern Metropolis and along the future NOL Main Line. The key environmental benefits could be derived by implementing the Project include:

- At present, there are about 22 ha of brownfields clustered in the Project Site, including logistics and freight operation, open storage, vehicle-related operation and warehouse / workshop, etc., which produce adverse environmental, traffic and visual impacts to the neighbourhood. With the proposed developments and infrastructures, land use efficiency would be enhanced and the overall environment in the area can be significantly improved.
- The Project will improve the existing sewerage infrastructure with new sewerage networks and a new sewage pumping station (SPS) which would benefit both the population of the nearby existing residential development / villages and the proposed developments under the Project. Water quality would be improved by the introduction of new sewerage network to the currently unsewered areas.
- Existing villages and residential developments can be benefited from the newly planned GIC facilities, open space and improved rail-and-road transport

connectivity, and other infrastructure services brought by the Project. These enhancements provide collective benefit and contribute to improve the quality of life of the existing villages and residential developments in the vicinity of the Project.

17.3 Environmentally Friendly Design

17.3.1 To foster an eco-friendly and low-carbon community, the Project will implement sustainable planning and urban design principles, incorporating existing green and natural assets. The Project will integrate smart and green mobility solutions. Additionally, an integrated infrastructure system will be implemented, encompassing sustainable building design, urban greening, and efficient waste management facilities.

17.3.2 Similar to Hong Kong's earlier successful river revitalisation initiatives, the treatments for the Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel (NTMDC) would include channel widening, flattening of the southern riverbank, as well as incorporating green and eco-conservation elements, such as planting a variety of vegetation and mimicking natural stream environments, are proposed for the revitalisation of NTMDC. The slopes of NTMDC will be transformed into planting areas, and new plantings including riparian species would be introduced to enhance aquatic habitats and support the implementation of blue-green infrastructure. The planting of native vegetation and creation of wildlife environments will also maximise biodiversity and promote environmental sustainability. These treatments would bring positive impacts to the nature, as well as the future population of NTM, whereby the overall ecological value and biodiversity would increase. It is expected that the enhanced habitats could provide more ecological resources for the waterbirds species of conservation importance, such as Citrine Wagtail, Great Egret, Little Egret and White-throated Kingfisher.

17.3.3 The Project promotes sustainable, low-carbon mobility and active lifestyles through a comprehensive, people-centered network of pedestrian walkways and cycle tracks. This network connects key destinations – including UniTown, Integrated Hospital, public transport hubs, residential neighbourhood, retail outlets and community facilities – via elevated, covered, and barrier-free routes. The open space provision meet the enhanced provision of 3.5 m^2 per person under Hong Kong 2030+. The robust cycling network integrates with existing tracks, including connections to the New Territories Cycle Track Network along Castle Peak Road and an arterial route connecting major activity nodes across the NTM New Development Area (NDA).

17.3.4 Preservation of points of local historical interests has been considered in the RODP, taking into account the public comments obtained during the public engagement, to promote cultural sustainability. Notably, Wai Cheung Ancestral Hall (HB1219) is proposed to be preserved in situ, allowing flexibility for future adaptive use within a planned open space. The open space surrounding HB1219 could be utilised for public to interact, relax hold local community events. Subject to the detailed design in later stage, the former Yau Tam Mei Primary School (YTMT06), valued for its social significance, as a sole source of education in Yau Tam Mei Tsuen connecting many descendants of the village, and possesses some historical value as an embodiment of various acts of local benevolence recorded throughout its history, is also proposed to be preserved in situ within UniTown for potential adaptive reuse. This could provide the future students/teaching staff with a tangible link to the educational past of NTM. It is worth to note that both buildings are neither declared monument nor

graded historic building, and their preservation, conservation and protection is not required under EIAO-TM.

17.4 Key Environmental Problem Avoided and Environmentally Sensitive Areas Protected

17.4.1 This section summarises the key environmentally friendly designs adopted in the RODP to avoid, minimise and mitigate environmental impacts. Some of these approaches have contributed to avoid a number of environmental problems and to protect a number of environmentally sensitive areas and are presented in **Table 17.1** below.

Table 17.1 Summary of Key Environmental Issues Avoided / Minimised and Sensitive Areas Protected

Design Approaches	Environmental Issues Avoided/Minimised and Sensitive Areas Protected
Avoidance of Impact on Sites of Conservation Importance	• Encroachment of Lam Tsuen Country Park (LTCP), Conservation Area (CA), Wetland Conservation Area (WCA), Priority Site for Enhanced Conservation and Other Specified Uses (Wetland Conservation Park) (OU(WCP)) have been avoided.
Avoidance/Minimisation of Ecological Impact on Pond Habitat	• Impact to the ponds which are considered to have moderate ecological value, to the west of San Tin Highway have been avoided.
Incorporation of Wildlife Corridor and Animal Barriers Design	• Incorporation of wildlife corridor and animal barriers design will be adopted during the detailed design of the proposed road connection to/from STT to mitigate habitat fragmentation and maintain the movement access for non-flying mammals including species of conservation importance.
Preservation of Natural Habitats	• Sites GB.1 and GB.2 have been retained in the RODP such that the loss of natural habitats and the associated flora species of conservation importance could be avoided.
Revitalisation of NTMDC	• NTMDC will be revitalised to serve as green buffer, enhancing biodiversity as well as the overall ecological value.
Avoidance of Impact from the Existing Odour Sources (i.e. chicken farms, LBF and TMB STP)	• The planned air sensitive receivers (ASRs) have been proposed to be situated away from existing odour sources. • Height restriction of air sensitive uses including openable window, fresh air intake and recreational use in open space at concerned sites that fall within odour exceedance zone of existing odour sources has been proposed.
Clearing of Existing Odour Sources	• A chicken farm within the Project Site will be removed to minimise the odour impact to the planned ASRs under the Project.
Provision of Sustainable Transport Infrastructure to Promote Low-carbon Living	• Pedestrian-friendly environment and robust cycling network has been proposed in the RODP to promote walkability and cycling for low-carbon living.
Proper Design of Transport Interchange Hub (TIH) and Public Transport Terminus (PTT)	• Operational fixed noise impacts from the proposed TIH and PTT to noise sensitive receivers (NSRs) are avoided.

Design Approaches	Environmental Issues Avoided/Minimised and Sensitive Areas Protected
Provision of Direct Road Traffic Noise Mitigation Measures	• NSRs will be protected to achieve the statutory road traffic noise requirement through adoption of direct noise mitigation measures such as provision of LNRS, absorptive type noise barriers, and acoustic windows/balconies or acoustic windows/balconies lined with sound absorptive material.
Preservation of Points of Local Historical Interests	• Local resources such as Wai Cheung Ancestral Hall and the former Yau Tam Mei Primary School will be preserved in situ within the Project Site in the RODP. • Flexibility for potential adaptive reuse of building structures by future project proponents of UniTown is also allowed in the RODP for former Yau Tam Mei Primary School.
Implementation of an Environmental Monitoring and Audit Programme during Construction and Operational Phases	• To ensure that all the recommended measures are in place.

17.5 Environmental Protection Measures Recommended

17.5.1 Mitigation measures were recommended to further reduce the environmental impacts due to the construction and operation of the Project. Key recommended mitigation measures / good site practices / enhancement measures and their associated benefits are summarised in **Table 17.2** below.

Table 17.2 Summary of Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures and their Associated Benefits

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
Air Quality	Construction Phase • Implement appropriate air quality control measures and good site practices, such as regular watering, provision of hoardings on works sites in proximity to ASRs, avoidance or covering of open stockpiles, etc. • Avoid the use of exempted non-road mobile machinery (NRMMs) and deploy electrified NRMMs as far as practicable. Operational Phase • Adopt appropriate odour control measures for the proposed SPS, such as enclosure of odour sources with negative pressure, provision of odour removal system with odour removal efficiency of at least 95% (>99.5% removal for H_2S) at the ventilation exhaust, locating the exhaust of the	• Protect ASRs by reducing fugitive dust emissions and exhaust emissions from construction plant and equipment • Minimise the potential odour impact on the ASRs

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	deodouriser furthest away and pointing away from any ASRs as far as practicable. • Locate air sensitive uses, including openable windows, fresh air intake and recreational use in open space, outside the odour exceedance zone.	
Noise	<u>Construction Phase</u> • Adopt quieter construction methods, quiet Powered Mechanical Equipment (PME) including Quality Powered Mechanical Equipment (QPME), temporary movable noise barriers, noise insulating fabric, noise enclosures, silencers and good site practices to mitigate the construction noise impact. <u>Operational Phase</u> • Implement direct mitigation measures, including the application of low noise road surfacing material, vertical and cantilevered absorptive type noise barriers, and acoustic windows/balconies or acoustic windows/balconies lined with sound absorptive material at concerned planned residential sites. • Select proper quiet fixed plants and provide acoustic measures where necessary for the planned fixed noise sources to ensure compliance with relevant noise standards at all NSRs.	• Protect NSRs by mitigating construction and operational noise
Water Quality	<u>Construction Phase</u> • Implement the mitigation measures as detailed in the Professional Persons Environmental Consultative Committee Practice Note (ProPECC PN) 2/24 Construction Site Drainage and Environment, Transport and Works Bureau Technical Circular (Works) (ETWB TC (W)) No. 5/2005 Protection of natural streams / rivers from adverse impacts arising from construction works, as well as other good site practices to minimise the potential water quality impacts from the construction activities.	• Protect the neighbouring water sensitive receivers (WSRs) during construction and operational phases

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	• Discharge surface run-off from construction sites into storm drains via adequately designed sand/silt removal facilities such as sand traps, silt traps and sedimentation basins. • Undertake all the construction works related to the removal/diversion of watercourses, including revitalisation works at the NTMDC, and removal/filling of ponds in dry conditions and physically separate from the watercourses nearby, for example, by provision of concrete blocks, sandbag barriers or other appropriate measures, prior to the aforementioned construction works. <u>Operational Phase</u> • Avoid exposed surfaces as far as practicable. • Provide screening facilities at the inlet of drainage system. • Regular maintenance of stormwater drainage system. • Adopt various blue-green infrastructures including but not limited to rainwater harvesting, use of porous paving materials and green roofs. • Incorporate precautionary measures in the design of the proposed SPS and develop a Contingency Plan to deal with the emergency discharges from the SPS.	
Sewerage and Sewage Treatment Implications	• Consider proper sewage septicity control measures for the proposed SPS and rising mains, such as direct injection of oxygen into the rising mains and pre-aeration in the wet well of the proposed SPS. • Consider the use of non-dosing solutions prior to dosing solutions.	• Avoid adverse impact on the existing and planned sewerage systems
Waste Management Implications	<u>Construction Phase</u> • Implement good site practices and waste reduction measures (e.g. reuse of construction and demolition (C&D) material where practicable before off-site disposal or develop a materials recovery and recycling programme during construction and operation).	• Minimise waste generation • Ensure proper handling of chemical waste and clinical waste • Ensure the C&D materials are disposed of at the designated outlets

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	• Implement a trip-ticket system for each works contract in accordance with DEVB TC(W) No. 6/2010 to ensure that the disposal of C&D materials is properly documented and verified. • Adopt Global Positioning System (GPS) or equivalent system for tracking and monitoring of all dump trucks engaged for the Project in recording their travel routings and parking locations to prohibit illegal dumping and landfilling of inert and non-inert C&D materials. • Handle chemical waste in accordance with the Code of Practice on the Packaging, Labelling and Storage of Chemical Wastes, and disposal of chemical waste at licensed chemical waste recycling / treatment facilities. <u>Operational Phase</u> • Handle clinical waste in accordance with Code of Practice for the Management of Clinical Waste - Major Clinical Waste Producers and Waste Collectors published under Section 35 of Waste Disposal Ordinance (WDO).	
Land Contamination	• Carry out further land contamination assessment, including further site appraisal and submission of Contamination Assessment Plan (CAP)(s), for the whole Project Site at a later stage of the Project when site access is available to confirm the existing land uses / activities, identify the presence of any potential contamination sources, and address any new contamination issues. • Carry out the associated site investigation (SI) works and any necessary remediation action after the operation of concerned site(s) has ceased but prior to the commencement of construction works and submit Contamination Assessment Report (CAR)(s) to present the findings of the works. • Submit Remediation Action Plan (RAP)(s) to Environmental Protection Department (EPD) for approval if contamination is identified.	• Identify and treat, if necessary, the land contamination identified prior to the construction works to avoid potential risk to workers and future occupants

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	• Conduct remediation works according to the approved RAP(s), if necessary, and submit Remediation Report (RR)(s) to EPD for endorsement before commencement of any construction works.	
Ecology	<u>Design and/or Operational Phases</u> • Avoid direct impact on recognised sites of conservation importance within the assessment area. • Revitalise NTMDC and provide non-building area or "Open Space" along both sides of NTMDC and peripheral tree planting as screening. • Preserve the mixed woodland at the southern part of the Project Site. • Explore the feasibility to adopt Modular Integrated Construction (MiC) technology for construction works within the WBA in the detailed design stage. • Incorporate wildlife corridor and animal barriers design at the proposed road connection to/from STT. • Provide embed/superimpose opaque strips or opaque dots/visual markers on proposed noise barriers. • Use non-transparent or non-glaring building materials. • Provide tree planting at the eastern margin as screening. • Explore greening opportunities. <u>Construction Phase</u> • Conduct pre-construction survey and transplantation / translocation for flora/fauna species of conservation importance. • Conduct pre-construction survey and nest control measures for White-throated Kingfisher. • Provide wetland compensation site. • Provide temporary access for wildlife, screen hoardings/fencings. • Adopt phased construction works for revitalisation works in NTMDC, and undertake the revitalisation works in dry season. • Provide suitable lighting in construction sites, use directional	• Avoid and/or minimise direct impacts on recognised sites of conservation importance • Preserve the major bird flight corridor within NTM NDA • Enhance the ecological value of the existing NTMDC • Avoid and/or minimise direct impacts on mixed woodland habitat and associated wildlife species • Avoid and/or minimise disturbance to recognised sites of conservation importance and the associated species of conservation importance and wildlife • Maintain the ecological linkage of the vegetated area in both eastern and western side of the proposed road connection at Ngau Tam Shan • Avoid and/or minimise impacts on bird collision • Minimise the potential disturbance impacts with tree planting as screening • Enhance the overall habitat quality and ecological connection of the Development Area with the surrounding habitats • Avoid and/or minimise direct impacts to flora/fauna species of

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	lighting and control night-time lighting period. • Provide screening (e.g. hoarding) for demarcation of the construction site. • Adopt general good site practice, noise, air and water quality mitigation measures.	conservation importance • Avoid and/or minimise direct impacts to nest of White-throated Kingfisher • Compensate for the unavoidable loss of marsh/reed and natural watercourse • Maintain the ecological linkage at Ngau Tam Shan and prevent and minimise non-flying mammal species from entering the construction site • Minimise the extent of concurrent temporary loss of channel habitat as well as the loss of foraging ground within the Project Site at the same period • Reduce the potential water quality impacts during the works within the NTMDC • Avoid and/or minimise night-time disturbance • Avoid and/or minimise disturbance impact to the recognised sites of conservation importance, other ecologically sensitive resources and avoid an unintentionally access to the nearby natural habitats • Avoid and/or minimise potential noise, air and water quality impact
Fisheries	<u>Construction Phase</u> • Isolate and disconnect all the affected fishponds from any existing watercourses. • Drain the ponds before filling up or before commencement of any excavation or construction works. • Implement shoring / sheet pile wall which should have grouting or a grout curtain to avoid water seepage from the affected fishpond to the adjacent area.	• Minimise potential water quality impact to the adjacent water bodies • Maintain bund stability

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	Construction & Operational Phases • Implement water quality measures.	
Landscape and Visual	Construction Phase • Preserve existing vegetation as far as practicable • Minimise disturbance on watercourses • Carefully manage construction facilities and activities • Reinstate temporarily disturbed landscape areas • Erect decorative screen hoarding Operational Phase • Compensate loss of existing trees by tree planting in a ratio of 1:1 in terms of number as far as practicable • Provide roadside and amenity planting • Incorporate sensitive and aesthetically pleasing design of aboveground structures • Provide buffer planting • Provide green roof • Revitalisation of NTMDC to create a blue-green network • Maximise greening on building structures and surfaces	• To minimise and mitigate any adverse landscape and visual impacts during construction and operational phases
Cultural Heritage	Design Phase - Built Heritage • Review any proposed revitalisation for HB1219 in later stages by future project proponent(s) or subsequent developer(s). • Explore opportunity for potential revitalisation of YTMT06 (if preserved in situ) by future project proponent(s) or subsequent developer(s). Construction Phase - Built Heritage • Conduct cartographic and photographic record, and other documentation means (including 3D scanning) for items that will be subject to direct impact (i.e. demolition) prior to the commencement of any construction works by the contractor(s) at the respective locations for record purposes and future use, such as research, exhibition and educational programmes. • Implement standard control measures on ground-borne vibration, tilting and settlement by	• To avoid or minimise the potential impacts to the concerned other identified items and archaeological resources

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	the future contractor(s) by drawing necessary references from relevant government guidelines on other identified items when there are construction works nearby. • Carry out standard measures of condition survey for HB1219 and YTMT06 (if preserved in situ) to better understand its physical structural condition. A post-construction condition survey should also be carried out to confirm its structural stability. • Reserve a buffer zone for HB1219 and YTMT06 (if preserved in situ) by the project proponent or its contractor(s) according to the results of the pre-construction condition survey in the design layout of the Project to mitigate potential adverse vibration impact arising from construction works. • Provide protective covering or sheltering for HB1219 and YTMT06 (if preserved in situ) during construction activities in proximity to avoid potential damages through direct contact with construction machineries. • Adopt dust suppression measures and good site practice by the contractor(s) during the construction phase to avoid dust nuisance on HB1219, YTMT05 and YTMT06 (if preserved in situ). • Maintain a safe access route to HB1219, YTMT05 and YTMT06 (if preserved in situ) by the contractor(s) for conducting mitigation measures. • Deploy management measures by the contractor(s), such as briefing to site staff before commencement of construction works and posting notices at site office(s), to be aware of the other identified items in close proximity. <u>Construction Phase - Archaeology</u> • Conduct archaeological excavation at the Project Site within Ngau Tam Mei Site of Archaeological Interest (SAI) before the commencement of works involving soil disturbance.	

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	• Conduct archaeological survey-cum-excavation at the NTM Archaeologically Sensitive Area (ASA) and NTM (North) ASA within the Project Site before the commencement of works involving soil disturbance at the concerned areas. • Conduct archaeological survey at the low-lying agricultural fields and hilly landscape within the Project Site where possess moderate-low archaeological potential. • As a precautionary measure and pursuant to the *Antiquities and Monuments Ordinance (Cap. 53)*, the project proponent is required to inform the Antiquities and Monuments Office (AMO) immediately in case of discovery of antiquities or supposed antiquities in the course of works, so that appropriate mitigation measures, if needed, can be timely formulated and implemented in agreement with and to the satisfaction of AMO.	
Hazard to Life	Not Required	N/A
Landfill Gas	<u>Design / Construction Phase</u> • Set up a protective barrier at the point where a utility passes through the perimeter of the Consultation Zone (CZ) of Ngau Tam Mei Landfill (NTML) such that trench excavations do not form a route for gas migration. • Fill the void around any service ducts, pipes or cables within conduits at the point where the trench passes through the perimeter of the CZ of NTML with gas resistant mastic. • Designate service runs within the CZ of NTML as “special routes” and inform utility companies so that they could consider implementing precautionary measures such as ensuring staff members are aware of the potential hazards of working in confined spaces (e.g. manholes and service chambers), and that appropriate monitoring procedures are in place to prevent hazards due to asphyxiating atmospheres in confined spaces.	To avoid or minimise potential impacts, if any, to the surrounding areas and staff members.

Environmental Aspect	Key Recommended Mitigation Measures / Good Site Practices / Enhancement Measures	Associated Benefits
	• Monitor the presence of landfill gas for excavations of 1 m depth within the CZ of NTML before entry and periodically during the works. • Adopt the procedures for safety management and working procedures described in EPD's Landfill Gas Hazard Assessment Guidance Note if drilling is required.	
Electric and Magnetic Fields	Not Required	N/A

17.6 Population and Environmentally Sensitive Areas Protected

17.6.1 The Project has avoided encroachment into ecological sensitive areas, including LTCP, CA, WCA, Priority Site for Enhanced Conservation and OU(WCP). With careful planning and design of the Project, together with the implementation of mitigation measures recommended in this EIA Report, the population in the vicinity of the Project during construction and operational phases have been planned to be protected by mitigation measures from various environmental impacts.

17.7 Compensation Site

17.7.1 The loss of wetland habitat would be compensated at the proposed wetland compensation site situated between Tsing Long Highway and San Tam Road at Sha Po area adjacent to Kam Tin River. This site is located at approximately 45 m west of the Park Yoho wetland Fairyland in Sha Po, which is a semi-natural brackish marsh constructed and managed under Park Yoho Phase 1 development. A mosaic of wetland habitats can also be found in Nam Sang Wai along Nam Sang Wai Road approximately 220 m west of the proposed wetland compensation site (across Kam Tin River). Two abandoned meanders and the associated marsh/reed habitats can also be found to the north and south of the proposed wetland compensation site, approximately 215 m and 315 m away respectively. Given the connectivity with the adjacent wetland habitats and ecological resources, this site has the potential to integrate and form a continuous wetland habitat with the surrounding areas, hence, it is considered with higher ecological potential as a compensation of marsh/reed habitat than other potential locations.